

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Basic key terms of government and contemporary issues

Lecture 2

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Key terms related to government

- **ACT**-An Act is a decree that is approved by the respective legislature
- **ADJOURN**-to end a meeting, usually for a stated time only.
- **AMENDMENT**-an addition to a constitution; a change in any bill or document by adding, substituting, or omitting a certain part before its final passage.
- **APPROPRIATION**-money set aside by a legislative body for some government expenditure.
- **BILL**-a measure introduced in either house of Congress.
 - **Public bill**--a bill of broad general application.
 - **Private bill**--a bill for the benefit of one or a few individuals.

Key terms related to government

- **BUDGET**-the document sent to parliament by the President in July-June of each year estimating government revenue and expenditures for the ensuing fiscal year and recommending appropriations in detail.
- **CALENDAR**-a legislative schedule; thus when a bill is reported from a committee of the House, it is placed upon a "calendar."
- **CAUCUS**-a meeting of party members in a legislative body to determine the party's stand on forthcoming issues.
- **ELECTION**-the process of choosing government officials by vote of the citizens.
- **FISCAL YEAR**-a 12-month period at the end of which accounts are reckoned.

Key terms related to government

- **HEARING**-a session of a congressional committee at which supporters and opponents of a proposed measure are given an opportunity to express their views.
- **LAW**-A law is defined as an assemblage of rules and regulations that are indispensable and must be followed.
- **LOBBY**-a group or person (lobbyist) seeking to influence legislators for the passage or defeat of legislation.
- **MAJORITY**-more than half, or the group that controls a vote of that size.
- **MINORITY**-less than half, or the group which controls only a minor fraction of the total vote.

Key terms related to government

- **MOTION**-a proposal on procedure or action presented to a legislative body.
- **RATIFICATION**-the act of approving an appointment or a treaty.

12 Contemporary Issues in Public Administration (1/2)

Protecting and Advancing Democracy

1. Ensure Electoral Integrity and Enhance Voter Participation
2. Modernize and Reinvigorate the Public Service
3. Develop New Approaches to Public Governance and Engagement
4. Advance National Interests in a Changing Global Context

Strengthening Social and Economic Development

5. Foster Social Equity
6. Connecting Individuals to Meaningful Work
7. Build Resilient Communities
8. Advance the Nation's Long-term Fiscal Health

12 Contemporary Issues in Public Administration (2/2)

Ensuring Environmental Sustainability

- 9. Steward Natural Resources and Address Climate Change
- 10. Create Modern Water Systems for Safe and Sustainable Use

Managing Technological Changes

- 11. Ensure Data Security and Privacy Rights of Individuals
- 12. Make Government Artificial intelligence (AI) Ready